



Language Learning

Mandarin tips, resources, and language exchange

CDISCOVERY

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HSK Exam Guide 2026: Levels, Registration, and Study

Tips

The HSK (Hanyu Shuiping Kaoshi) is the standardized test for Chinese language proficiency. Here's everything you need to know.

HSK Levels:

* HSK 1

* -- 150 characters, basic phrases. Listening + Reading. ~1 hour.

* HSK 2

* -- 300 characters, simple conversations. Listening + Reading. ~1.5 hours.

* HSK 3

* -- 600 characters, daily communication. Listening + Reading + Writing. ~2 hours.

* HSK 4

* -- 1,200 characters, fluent on familiar topics. Required for most university programs.

* HSK 5

* -- 2,500 characters, read Chinese newspapers, watch movies. Required for CSC
scholarships.

* HSK 6

* -- 5,000+ characters, near-native comprehension. Required for advanced programs.

How to Register:

* Visit

* chinesetests.cn

* Create account, select test center and date

* Fee: ¥150-950 depending on level

* Test dates: monthly at most centers

* Results available online within 3 weeks

Best Study Resources:

* Pleco

* -- Essential dictionary app with flashcards and OCR

* HelloChinese

* -- Best app for beginners (HSK 1-3)

* Du Chinese

* -- Graded reading app with pinyin toggle

* ChinesePod

* -- Audio lessons for all levels

* YoyoChinese

* -- YouTube channel with clear grammar explanations

* Anki

* -- Spaced repetition flashcards (use HSK decks)

Study Tips:

* Practice writing characters by hand -- helps with memory retention

* Learn radicals first -- they help you guess meanings of unfamiliar characters

* Watch Chinese shows with Chinese subtitles (not English!)

* Find a language partner on Tandem or HelloTalk

* Study 30 minutes daily rather than 3 hours once a week

Sources: Sources: [Confucius Institute Headquarters](http://www.hanban.org) • [HSK Official Registration](http://www.chinesetests.cn)

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Community Topics Guide

<https://cdiscovery-community.netlify.app/>

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